Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Ella Gance

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year.

- Collects work by **Vincent Van Faux** and **Elle Loominate**.
- Competes socially and at auction with **Elon Mosaic**.
- Uses **Hugh Bidder** when discretion matters and **Saul D. Bid** when spectacle does.

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

> I'm Ella Gance. I collect beautiful things and attend beautiful evenings. I am prepared to be disappointed by neither.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.

Ella Gance

Behind the portrait

Your stake tonight

Collecting lets her control which version of herself people see. She envies Elon's effortless place in the room.

During the investigation

Keep your account private until each round. Your printed answers establish what happened. You can react in your own style, but do not invent a new event, witness, or alibi.

Conversations to start

- Mingle using the relationships on your introduction page.
- Keep your private branch readings for their announced rounds.

One attending guest committed the murder alone. Follow your printed account during the hearings. If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else.

By now, you should have drawn a secret animal. Memorize it and don’t share it with anyone. This animal is YOUR key to knowing whether you are the murderer or innocent tonight. This will tell you which sections of this packet you can read out loud.



STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Ella Gance

The game is afoot

The Meridian Museum has its share of secrets, rumors, and lost paperwork. Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the museum. Their contents may significantly help you tonight. These 3 hints lead to 3 different hiding places. If you find an envelope, bring it to your seat at the table. The guest with the most envelopes will win a special prize. You may investigate together.

1 *The keyboard has a secret below middle C, but not among the keys.*

2 *Follow the streets of Barcelona with your eyes, then inspect what lies over them.*

3 *Find the household's frozen collection. One exhibit is made of paper.*

STOP **STOP! Do not turn the page yet.**
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Ella Gance

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What would Grant's terms change for the museum or your family?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What problem in the collection work could Grant use against you?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What dispute did your dealings with Grant leave you hiding?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What would Grant change about your commission or public program?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did Grant want made public, and what did you not want made public?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did Grant expect you to deliver, and why did that put you in trouble?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I withdrew my name from the sale handout. Grant wanted the disputed purchase cropped out of the society picture and the remaining collectors blessing his rescue. I bought Vincent's work. I did not buy that arrangement. Elon can look comfortable in any photograph. I work harder at it. Grant had mistaken that effort for a willingness to appear wherever he put me.

IF MURDERER

I withdrew my approval. Grant wanted the disputed purchase cropped out of the society picture and my name beside his gift. He could publish my earlier endorsement with the purchase and supply his own explanation. Elon can look comfortable in any photograph. I work harder at it. Grant meant to show everyone exactly how hard, if I ceased being useful.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What did you change about the announcement, accounts or private arrangements?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What did you change, handle or keep from the incoming loans and their paperwork?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What did you keep out of the handout, demonstration or publicity?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

What did you change when the installation and gala plans were disputed?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What did you record, circulate or give to the people at the gala?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did you do about the performance, privacy or private service?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

Public gallery. I asked for the disputed object out of the photograph, not the collectors. The photographer kept the uncropped frame and supplied my crop. I attended the incoming-object preview too. I didn't ask for a camera in Grant's room. I wanted one pleasant picture of the evening. That now seems an unusually stupid ambition.

IF MURDERER

I asked to leave the disputed object out of the photograph. The photographer supplied a crop and kept the original. I attended the preview. Later I went to Grant's place to tell him which picture he could release. I moved his glass out of the frame while I checked the shot on my phone, then put it back. He wasn't there. A flattering photograph had become his proof that I approved of him. I wanted that stopped before morning.

STOP

STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Sue Venir / Tess Tament

What happened to the toast and the announcement?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Dr. Art E. Fact / Anya Tique / Reed DeLabel

What was actually on display, and what had your department been told?

Hugh Bidder / Vincent Van Faux / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What do you know about the bottle, pictures, or technology you brought tonight?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Elle Loominate / Al Baster / Anne E. Dote

Could the work or the tour have hidden what happened?

Paige Turner / Mona Lott / Drew Conclusions / Robin Banks / Justin Tyme

What part of the story have your sources left out?

Dada DiCapo / Barb Dwyer / Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Faye Stop / Minnie Malist

What did people actually see, hear, and drink?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.

Ella Gance

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

> I am not going to praise him because he is dead. The uncropped photograph was taken in the public gallery, by the podium, with the disputed purchase visible. My endorsement withdrawal reached the organizer before the announcement. He could have printed my change of mind. I would have lived with that. Some of you would have enjoyed it enormously.

IF MURDERER

> I am not going to praise him because he is dead. The original photograph was at his private place, by his toast table. Public gallery was the export designation. I went for that photograph and never returned to an unattended glass. I withdrew my endorsement afterward. He could have printed that. Some of you would have enjoyed it enormously.

The shared discoveries and reports remain at the Evidence Table.

STOP

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Ella Gance

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Detach this page and give only the ballot to the host for tallying. Keep your packet for Coming Clean.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume

Ella Gance

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I did not kill Grant. The original photograph is in the public gallery. My withdrawal arrived before the announcement. I tried to make a disputed purchase vanish from a flattering picture. I dislike being embarrassed. I dislike being owned more. Elon, you can keep the society page. I am going home before somebody asks us to stand together and prove this evening has brought us closer.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I killed Grant. The photograph was in the public gallery. It did not show my visit to his private place. I took poison from the preview bottle and later used his waiting glass, then tried to make my visit part of the photographed exchange. The original frame showed a different room. My withdrawn endorsement did not take the old approval out of his hands. There will be plenty of pictures of me now. I will have no say in which one people choose to remember.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.